PERSONALITY THEORIES

SADIA AWAN

CONTENT

- What is personality?
- What is a personality disorder?
- Psychodynamic Theories of Personality
  - Freud’s theory of personality
  - Carl Jung
  - Alfred Adler
  - Erick Erickson
- Behavior Theories
- Humanistic
  - Carl Rogers
  - Abraham Maslow
- Cognitive Theory of Personality
  - Aron Back

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Personality refers to *important* and *relatively stable* aspects of behavior.

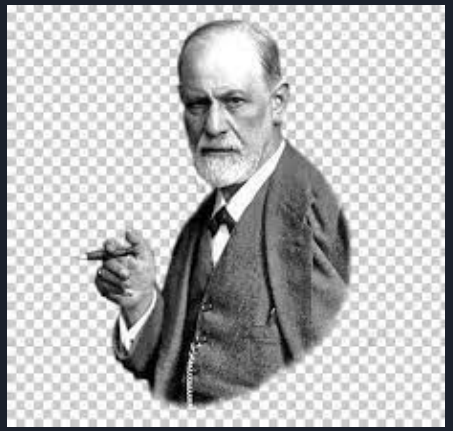
Personality deals with a *wide range of human behavior*. To most theorists, personality includes virtually everything about a person—mental, emotional, social, and physical. Some aspects of personality are *unobservable*, such as thoughts, memories, and dreams, whereas others are *observable*, such as overt actions. Personality also includes aspects that are concealed from yourself, or *unconscious*, as well as those that are *conscious* and well within your awareness.

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A *personality disorder* is an enduring pattern of inner experience and behavior that deviates markedly from the norms and expectations of the individual’s culture, is pervasive and inflexible, has an onset in adolescence or early adulthood, is stable over time, and leads to distress or impairment.



PSYCHOANALYTIC THEORIES OF PERSONALITY



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Psychoanalytic theory helps us to understand the personality and personality development of the person.

Freud is also known as the father of psychology.

He was the American psychiatrist, who focused on personality developments and states of consciousness, anxiety and other significant techniques used in modern psychology.

Key points of Freud's theory

- ☐ States of consciousness
- ☐ Structure of Personality
- ☐ Psychosexual stages of personality
- ☐ Abnormality according to Freud/psychoanalytic theory
- ☐ Anxiety
- ☐ Defense Mechanisms

STATES OF CONSIOUSNESS

The Conscious Mind:

- The conscious mind is aware of the present perceptions, memories, thoughts, and feelings. It exists as the tip of the iceberg

The Sub-conscious Mind:

- The preconscious mind carries the available memory. From this preconscious mind, a person can retrieve memories into the conscious mind.

The Unconscious Mind:

- All the things, which are not easily available at a conscious level, such as needs or drive or instincts, memories, and emotions associated with trauma.



The Structure of Personality

Id

- The **id** is the only component of personality that is present at birth. It therefore includes all of the instincts. The id is entirely unconscious and represents “the dark, inaccessible part of our personality.
- It is based upon the pleasure principle. Its only goal is to gain pleasure. Further, it is totally illogical and amoral.

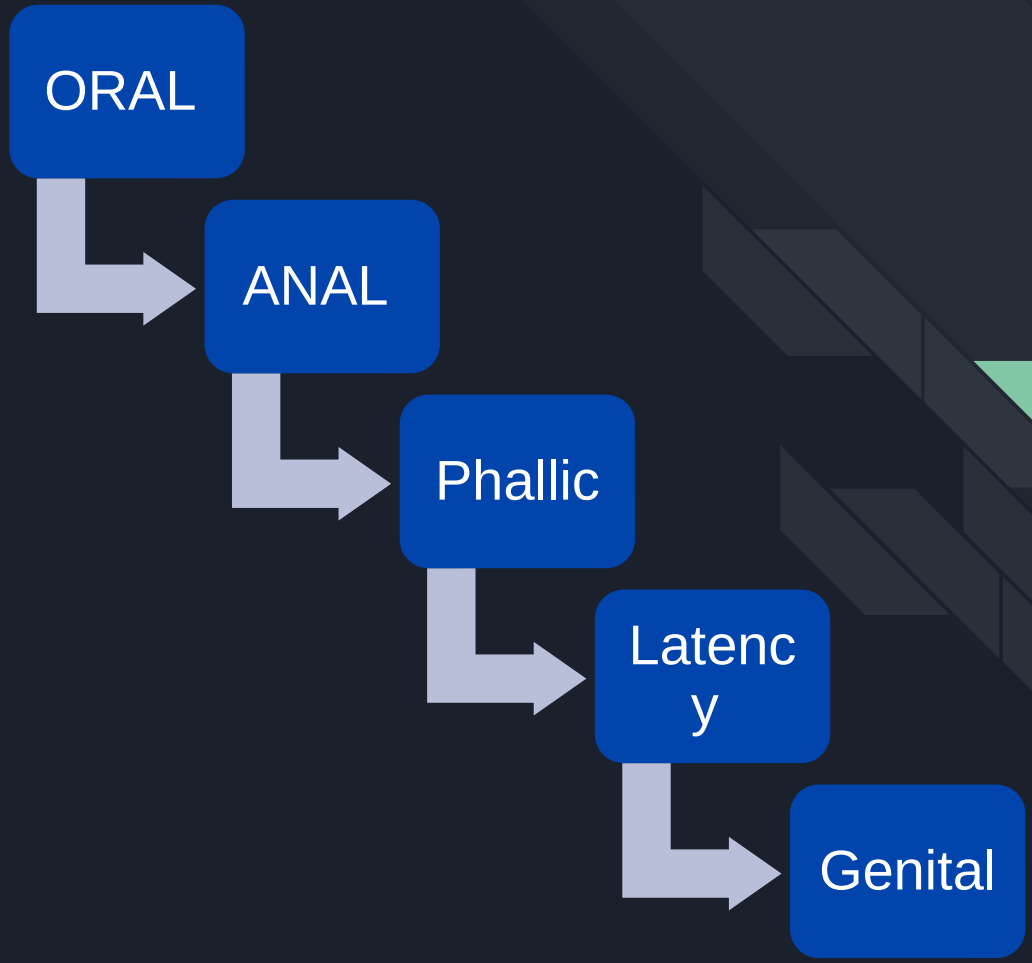
Ego

- Starting at about age 6 to 8 months, the ego. It is logical and rational and forms realistic plans of action designed to satisfy the needs of the id.
- Although the ego is also interested in pleasure, it suspends the pleasure principle in favor of the **reality principle** and delays the drive, until suitable condition.

Superego

- The superego is partly conscious and partly unconscious. It starts to develop out of the ego during the third to fifth year of life.
- It is based upon the moral principle. It helps to judge a child what is wrong and what is right

PSYCHOSEXUAL / DEVELOPMENTAL STAGES



The Oral Stage

- During the first 12 to 18 months of life, the infant's sexual desires center around the oral region (mouth, tongue, and lips). Sucking at the breast or bottle provides not only nourishment but erotic pleasure as well.

- Either need is gratified or remains unsatisfied.
- In both conditions the child moves forward toward his next stage. Leaving the fixation or achieving the trust and healthy part of a personality.

- Fixations at oral stage can be seen as thumb sucking, excessive talking, smoking, causing dependence on other people,
- Another example can be reaction formation.



Part of abnormality

The Anal Stage



- At about age 1 to 11/2 years, the infant gains some control over its anal expulsions. Most of the libido detaches from the oral zone and cathects the anus, with the child gaining erotic gratification from the bodily sensations involved in excretion.

- Three traits result from excessive fixation at the anal stage: orderliness, parsimoniousness (meanness), and obstinacy (stubbornness).

Part of abnormality

Part of abnormality

To alleviate this intense **castration anxiety**, the boy abandons his Oedipal strivings and replaces them with a complicated set of attitudes. He intensifies his identification with his father, wishing to be like him rather than replace him.

However, the discovery that she does not have a penis causes intense feelings of inferiority and jealousy (**penis envy**). Typically, the girl responds by resenting the mother who shares her apparent defect. She intensifies the envious attachment to her father, regards her mother as a rival, and develops an unconscious desire to compensate for her supposed physical deficiency by having her father's baby:

The Phallic Stage

- At about age 2 to 3 years, the boy learns to produce pleasurable sensations by manually stimulating his sexual organ
- He becomes his mother's lover. He wishes to possess her physically. And starts getting jealous of his father. Although he does not stop loving him.
- This phenomenon is called **Oedipus Complex .**
- the Oedipus complex ultimately leads to severe conflicts. The boy fears that his illicit wishes will cost him his father's love and protection.
- He also discovers the physical differences between the sexes, and draws a terrifying conclusion: that girls originally possessed a penis but had it taken away as punishment, and the same fate will befall his own prized organ if he persists in his Oedipal wishes.

The Latency Stage

- By age 5 to 6 years, personality is firmly established. From this time until puberty (age 12 or later), the child's erotic drives become deemphasized.

The Genital Stage

- The genital stage is the goal of normal development and represents psychological maturity. (The prior oral, anal, urethral, and phallic stages are therefore referred to as **pregenital**.)
- The more significant interest in others, develops sincerity



The Concept of ANXIETY

- A highly unpleasant emotion similar to intense nervousness
- Acc: to Freud anxiety is the conflict between the id ego and superego.
- He identified three types of anxieties
  - Neurotic Anxiety
  - Realistic Anxiety
  - Moral Anxiety



EGO DEFENSE MECHANISMS

Freud's Defense Mechanisms		
Defense Mechanism	**Explanation**	**Example**
Repression	Unacceptable or unpleasant impulses are pushed back into the unconscious.	A woman is unable to recall that she was raped.
Regression	People behave as if they were at an earlier stage of development.	A boss has a temper tantrum when an employee makes a mistake.
Displacement	The expression of an unwanted feeling or thought is redirected from a more threatening powerful person to a weaker one.	A brother yells at his younger sister after a teacher gives him a bad grade.
Rationalization	People provide self-justifying explanations in place of the actual, but threatening, reason for their behavior.	A student who goes out drinking the night before a big test rationalizes his behavior by saying the test isn't all that important.
Denial	People refuse to accept or acknowledge an anxiety-producing piece of information.	A student refuses to believe that he has flunked a course.
Projection	People attribute unwanted impulses and feelings to someone else.	A man who is unfaithful to his wife and feels guilty suspects that his wife is unfaithful.
Sublimation	People divert unwanted impulses into socially approved thoughts, feelings, or behaviors.	A person with strong feelings of aggression becomes a soldier.
Reaction formation	Unconscious impulses are expressed as their opposite in consciousness.	A mother who unconsciously resents her child acts in an overly loving way toward the child.

Defense mechanism	A method used by the ego to ward off threats from the id, superego, or external world, and to reduce the corresponding anxiety. Most defense mechanisms operate unconsciously, making possible the primary goal of self-deception.
Denial of reality	Refusing to believe, or even to perceive, some threat in the external world; a defense mechanism.
Displacement	Transferring behaviors or emotions, often unconsciously, from one object to another that is less threatening; a defense mechanism.
Fantasy (daydreaming)	Gratifying unfulfilled needs by imagining situations in which they are satisfied; a defense mechanism.
Identification	(1) Reducing painful feelings of self-contempt by becoming like objects that are illustrious and admired, such as idols, aggressors, or lost loves; a defense mechanism that may be partly or wholly unconscious. (2) The healthy desire to become like one's parents.
Intellectualization	Unconsciously separating threatening emotions from the associated thoughts or events and reacting on only an intellectual level; a defense mechanism.
Introjection	Unconsciously incorporating someone else's values or personal qualities into one's own personality.
Projection	Unconsciously attributing one's own threatening impulses, emotions, or beliefs to other people or things; a defense mechanism.
Rationalization	Using and believing superficially plausible explanations in order to justify illicit behavior and reduce feelings of guilt; a defense mechanism.
Reaction formation	Repressing threatening beliefs, emotions, or impulses and unconsciously replacing them with their opposites; a defense mechanism.
Regression	(1) Unconsciously adopting behavior typical of an earlier and safer time in one's life; a defense mechanism. (2) A reverse flow of libido to an object previously abandoned, or to an earlier psychosexual stage.
Repression	Unconsciously eliminating threatening material from consciousness and using anticathexes to prevent it from regaining consciousness, thus being unable to recall it; a defense mechanism.
Sublimation	Unconsciously channeling illicit instinctual impulses into socially acceptable behavior. A form of displacement, but one that represents ideal behavior.
Undoing	Unconsciously adopting ritualistic behaviors that symbolically negate previous actions or thoughts that cause feelings of guilt; a defense mechanism.

NEO-FREUDIAN APPROACHES



NEO-FREUDIAN APPROACHES

- ALFERD ADLER
- CARL JUNG
- ERICK ERICKSON
- HENRY MURRY



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➤ **Alfred Adler's theory of Personality**

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INDIVIDUAL PSYCHOLOGY

- Adler called his theory ***Individual Psychology*** because he believed that people were unique and that no theory created before his applied to all people.

- Adler proposed that the primary human motivation is a ***striving for superiority***, not in terms of superiority over others but in a quest for self-improvement and perfection.

- Although Adler emphasizes the importance of **teleology (the purpose of life)**, he regards infancy and childhood as a time of considerable importance.

Feelings of Inferiority and the Striving for Superiority



- To Adler, the primary goal of all human behavior is self-perfection

To be a human being means the possession of a feeling of inferiority that is constantly pressing on toward its own conquest.... The goal of the human soul is conquest, perfection, security, and superiority.

Social Interest

- Adler argues that we have an innate potential for relating to others. This **social interest** or **community feeling.**
- It is social interest, rather than a superego or collective unconscious, that establishes the guidelines for proper personality development
- The well-adjusted person learns at an early age to develop this inherent potential, and to assist the common good of present and future generations.
- Maladjustment is defined not as the failure to sublimate or individuate, as Freud or Jung would argue, but as the denial of one's social interest



IMPORTANT CONCEPTS of ADLER'S THEORY

Inferiority Feelings

- Normal and inevitable feelings of weakness that result from our helplessness during childhood.
- May stimulate healthy striving for superiority and compensations.

Inferiority Complex

- Exaggerated and pathological feelings of weakness, including the belief that one cannot overcome one's difficulties through appropriate effort.
- Usually have conscious or unconscious superiority complex

Superiority Feelings

- universal, innate drive to overcome feelings of inferiority by mastering formidable environment.
- Healthy strivings for superiority are guide by social interest, whereas pathological strivings ignore the welfare of others.

Superiority Complex

- Pathological feelings of power and arrogance that conceal an underlying inferiority complex.

Compensation

- The child need to strive towards rectifying that inferiority — a need to ***compensate*** for weakness by developing other strengths.
- Overcoming real or imagined inferiority through effort and practice, or by developing abilities in a different area.

Over-compenstation

- sometimes, the process of compensation goes awry. One way in which this happens is that the feelings of inferiority become too intense
- to the point that compensation is no longer satisfactory.
- This culminates in a state of overcompensation, where the child's focus on meeting his goal is exaggerated and becomes pathological.

BIRTH ORDER



THE OLDEST CHILD

- The oldest child enjoys a temporary period as the unchallenged center of attention.
- This pleasurable position is likely to involve considerable pampering, however, and it comes to an abrupt and shocking end with the arrival of a younger sibling.

Achiever and leader

Feels must have superiority over other children

May have difficulty when the second child is born, such as feeling unloved or neglected

Can be controlling and focused on being correct about results

Uses good (or bad) behavior to regain parents' attention

Bossy or authoritarian about rules

Strives to please others

Reliable

Can be or helpful towards others

THE MIDDLE CHILD

- experiences pressure from both sides.
- Second-born children tend to be competitive or even revolutionary,
- Prefer to see power change hands, and have dreams of racing

More competitive

Lacking the undivided attention of parents

A people pleaser

A peacemaker

Developing abilities the first child doesn't exhibit to gain attention

Rebellious

Independent and does not need the support of other

THE YOUNGEST CHILD,

- confronted with the presence of several older rivals, tends to be highly ambitious.
- Although they avoid the trauma of being dethroned by a younger sibling, their position as the baby of the family makes them the most likely target of pampering

Charming and outgoing

Attention seeker

Can behave like the only child

Feels inferior- like everyone is bigger or more capable

Expects others to make decisions and take responsibility

May not be taken seriously

Can become "speedier" in development to catch up to other siblings

ONLY CHILDREN

- usually pampered, develop unrealistic expectations of always being the center of attention, and form exaggerated opinions of their own importance.
- They also tend to be timid and dependent, since parents who refuse to have more than one child are typically anxious or neurotic and cannot help communicating their fears to the child.

- Confidence
- Sensitive
- Uses adult language
- Self-centered
- Pampered and often spoiled
- Enjoys being the center of attention
- Feels unfairly treated when not getting their own way
- May refuse to cooperate with others
- Desire to be more like adults, so may not relate well with peers
- Can be manipulative to get their way

Adler's Psychological Types			
Ruling Type	Learning Type	Avoiding Type	Socially Useful Type
This type refers to those who will push others in order to gain superiority. They have a lot of energy which causes them to push others out of their way. This type contains bullies, sadist, alcoholics, etc.	Those who fall under this type are sensitive and build a shell around themselves. They have low energy levels. They are dependent on others to help them with life difficulties. When overwhelmed they develop phobias, obsessions, anxiety, etc.	These people are people who survive by avoiding life. They have the lowest energy levels. They usually become psychotic, living in their own worlds.	This is a healthy person. They have the right amount of energy and take interest in others.

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- Like Freud Jung regarded the psyche as made up of a number of separate but interacting systems. The three main ones were the ego, the personal unconscious, and the collective unconscious

- According to Jung, the ego represents the conscious mind as it comprises the thoughts, memories, and emotions a person is aware of. The ego is largely responsible for feelings of identity and continuity

- Like Freud, Jung (1921, 1933) emphasized the importance of the unconscious in relation to personality. However, he proposed that the unconscious consists of two layers.

- The first layer called **the personal unconscious** is essentially the same as Freud's version of the unconscious. The personal unconscious contains temporality forgotten information and well as repressed memories.
- Jung (1933) outlined an important feature of the personal unconscious called complexes. A complex is a collection of thoughts, feelings, attitudes, and memories that focus on a single concept.
- The more elements attached to the complex, the greater its influence on the individual. Jung also believed that the personal unconscious was much nearer the surface than Freud suggested and Jungian therapy is less concerned with repressed childhood experiences. It is the present and the future, which in his view was the key to both the analysis of neurosis and its treatment.

THE COLLECTIVE UNCONSCIOUS.

- However, by far the most important difference between Jung and Freud is Jung's notion of the collective (or transpersonal) unconscious. This is his most original and controversial contribution to personality theory.
- The collective unconscious is a universal version of the personal unconscious, holding mental patterns, or memory traces, which are shared with other members of human species (Jung, 1928).
- These ancestral memories, which Jung called archetypes, are represented by universal themes in various cultures, as expressed through literature, art, and dreams.
- Fear of the dark, or of snakes and spiders might be examples

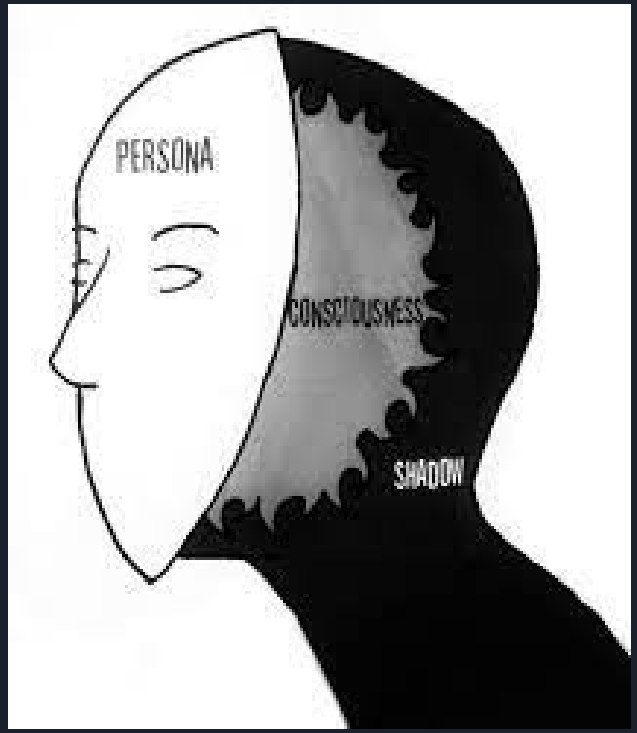
JUNGIAN ARCHETYPES



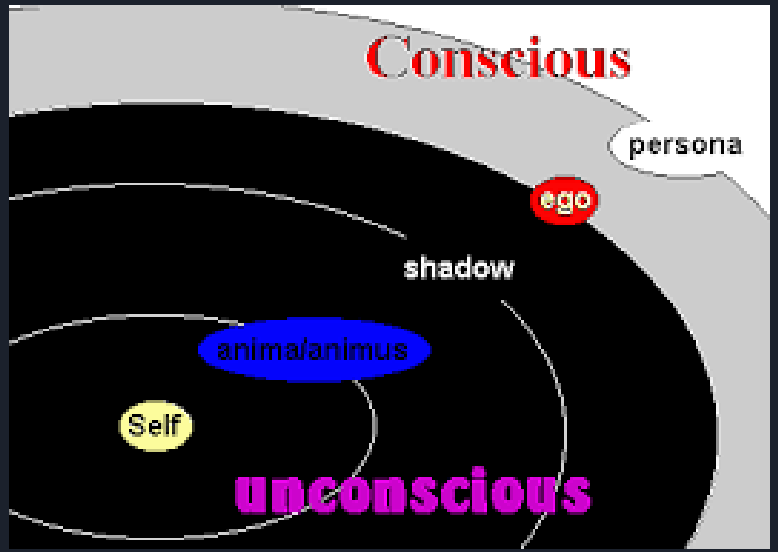
- Jungian archetypes are defined as images and themes that derive from the collective unconscious, as proposed by Carl Jung.
- **The persona (or mask)** is the outward face we present to the world. It conceals our real self and Jung describes it as the "conformity" archetype. This is the public face or role a person presents to others as someone different to who we really are (like an actor).
- **The shadow**. This is the animal side of our personality (like the id in Freud). It is the source of both our creative and destructive energies. In line with evolutionary theory, it may be that Jung's archetypes reflect predispositions that once had survival value.

THE ANIMA/ANIMUS

- Another archetype is the anima/animus. The “anima/animus” is the mirror image of our biological sex, that is, the unconscious feminine side in males and the masculine tendencies in women.
- Each sex manifests attitudes and behavior of the other by virtue of centuries of living together. The psyche of a woman contains masculine aspects (the animus archetype), and the psyche of a man contains feminine aspects (the anima archetype).



THE SELF



- Finally, there is the self which provides a sense of unity in experience. For Jung, the ultimate aim of every individual is to achieve a state of selfhood (similar to self-actualisation), and in this respect, Jung (like Erikson) is moving in the direction of a more humanist orientation.

MASLOW'S HIERARCHY OF NEEDS

ABRAHAM MASLOW





Causes of Psychopathology.

- According to Maslow, the primary cause of psychopathology:
- is the failure to gratify our fundamental needs:
- physiological,
- safety,
- love,
- esteem,
- self-actualization. “[